

D221

Organizational Systems and Healthcare Transformation

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

On a 28-bed unit known for friendly staff, a nurse with a clean record reads a correct order but the pump's confusing screen layout leads her to enter 100 mL/h instead of 10 mL/h. She catches and reports it right away. Under just culture, which response fits?

- A. Console the nurse and fix the system factors, such as the pump interface.
- B. Discipline her because the potential harm was high.
- C. Coach her for at-risk behavior.
- D. Never hold staff accountable for any error.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A nurse routinely skips the independent double-check on insulin because “everyone does it and nothing bad has happened.” How does just culture classify and address this?

- A. Reckless behavior; terminate her.
- B. No action, since no harm has occurred.
- C. At-risk behavior; coach the nurse and remove the incentives that make skipping normal.
- D. Human error; console the nurse.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A clinic team with a new electronic check-in kiosk tested text-message reminders with 20 patients for two weeks. They compared results with their prediction and confirmed no-shows in that group fell from 18% to 9%. The clinic manager is planning a staff lunch. What is the next PDSA step?

- A. Do: run the same test again with the same 20 patients.
- B. Roll out to every clinic at once, since one success proves it works everywhere.
- C. Plan: write the original aim statement.
- D. Act: decide to adopt or adapt the change and plan a larger test.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In which PDSA phase does a team compare the data it collected with the prediction it made?

- A.** Study
- B.** Plan
- C.** Act
- D.** Do

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A patient received the wrong heparin dose at a hospital that had just won a safety award. The review found look-alike vials stored side by side, a pharmacy check skipped during a computer outage, and a nurse on a double shift. The nurse is well liked. Which approach best reflects systems thinking?

- A.** Treat it as a one-off, since the hospital just won a safety award.
- B.** Do a root cause analysis and redesign vial storage, outage backups, and staffing.
- C.** Retrain the nurse on heparin dosing.
- D.** Terminate the nurse to show safety is taken seriously.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A unit with a new mural in its lobby tracks the percentage of patients whose fall-risk assessment is completed within 4 hours of admission. The unit has 32 beds. In Donabedian's model, what is this measure?

- A.** An outcome, because "within 4 hours" is a result
- B.** A structure measure
- C.** A process measure
- D.** An outcome measure

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which of these is a structure measure?

- A.** Nurse-to-patient ratio on the unit
- B.** Falls per 1,000 patient days
- C.** Patient-reported pain relief after discharge
- D.** Percentage of patients reassessed every shift

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

Two knee-replacement programs at hospitals with similar parking fees report results. Program A costs \$30,000 per case, and 90% of patients reach target function at 90 days. Program B costs \$20,000 per case, and 90% reach target function. Program B's surgeons are newer. Which program delivers more value?

- A. They are equal, because outcomes match.
- B. Program B, because it achieves the same outcome for less cost.
- C. Program A, because its surgeons are more experienced.
- D. Program A, because higher spending means better care.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Program X reaches the target outcome in 80% of patients at \$16,000 per case. Program Y reaches it in 90% at \$17,100 per case. Which has the lower cost per successful outcome?

- A. They are equal, since both succeed more than 75% of the time
- B. Program X, because its cost per case is \$1,100 lower
- C. Program Y, about \$19,000 per successful outcome
- D. Program X, \$12,800 per successful outcome

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

An 82-year-old patient with advanced heart failure at a hospital that just opened a new wing tells the team she wants to go home rather than have another procedure. Her son, who lives out of state, wants everything done. She has decision-making capacity. What is the patient-centered action?

- A. Follow the son's wishes, since he is the next of kin.
- B. Honor her informed choice through shared decision-making and plan support for care at home.
- C. Always defer to the family when there is conflict.
- D. Proceed with the procedure, because clinicians know what is best.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

At a hospital pursuing high reliability, a new respiratory therapist notices a ventilator alarm setting that looks wrong during rounds led by a senior attending. The hospital has 600 beds. Which HRO principle should guide the team?

- A. Reluctance to simplify
- B. Deference to the most senior person present.
- C. Preoccupation with failure, meaning all procedures stop until reviewed.
- D. Deference to expertise: the therapist speaks up and the team listens, regardless of rank.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

An emergency department with a new coffee bar maps its process and finds patients wait 40 minutes between triage and being roomed while exam rooms sit empty. Which Lean response fits?

- A. Hire more triage nurses.
- B. Build a larger waiting room.
- C. Label it overproduction waste.
- D. Treat the wait as waste and redesign patient flow so empty rooms are filled immediately.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

On a 28-bed unit ~~known for friendly staff~~, a nurse ~~with a clean record~~ reads a correct order but the pump's confusing screen layout leads her to enter 100 mL/h instead of 10 mL/h. She catches and reports it right away. Under just culture, which response fits?

Target word: just culture response **Decides:** An unintended slip driven by design = human error.

A	Correct	Human error is consoled; the design is corrected.
B	Adjacent category	Judges by outcome severity rather than behavior.
C	Confusion set	At-risk behavior is a conscious drift from safe practice; this was a slip.
D	Absolute language	Just culture still sanctions reckless behavior.

2. Answer C Concept 1 · transfer

A nurse routinely skips the independent double-check on insulin because "everyone does it and nothing bad has happened." How does just culture classify and address this?

Target word: classify the behavior **Decides:** A choice where risk is not recognized or is believed justified = at-risk.

A	Adjacent category	Reckless means consciously disregarding a substantial risk; she does not see the risk.
B	Inverted operation	Just culture judges behavior, not outcome.
C	Correct	Drift from safe practice is coached, and system pressures are examined.
D	Confusion set	It is a repeated choice, not an unintended slip.

3. Answer D Concept 2

A clinic team ~~with a new electronic check-in kiosk~~ tested text-message reminders with 20 patients for two weeks. They compared results with their prediction and confirmed no-shows in that group fell from 18% to 9%. ~~The clinic manager is planning a staff lunch.~~ What is the next PDSA step?

Target word: next PDSA phase **Decides:** Study is complete; Act comes next.

A	Inverted operation	Moves backward instead of acting on the results.
B	Absolute language	PDSA scales up through successive tests.
C	Confusion set	The aim was set before the test began.
D	Correct	Act follows Study and sets up the next cycle.

4. Answer A Concept 2 · transfer

In which PDSA phase does a team compare the data it collected with the prediction it made?

Target word: phase from activity **Decides:** Comparing results to prediction = Study.

A	Correct	Study analyzes results against the prediction.
B	Inverted operation	Plan makes the prediction, before any data exist.
C	Adjacent category	Act decides what to do with what was learned.
D	Confusion set	Do carries out the test and collects data.

5. Answer B Concept 3

A patient received the wrong heparin dose at a hospital ~~that had just won a safety award~~. The review found look-alike vials stored side by side, a pharmacy check skipped during a computer outage, and a nurse on a double shift. ~~The nurse is well liked~~. Which approach best reflects systems thinking?

Target word: systems response **Decides:** Several defenses failed together.

A	Camouflage	Past awards do not remove present system weaknesses.
B	Correct	Fixes each failed layer, not only the last person.
C	Dropped element	Ignores storage, outage, and staffing factors.
D	Adjacent category	A person-focused response that leaves the holes open.

6. Answer C Concept 4

A unit ~~with a new mural in its lobby~~ tracks the percentage of patients whose fall-risk assessment is completed within 4 hours of admission. ~~The unit has 32 beds~~. In Donabedian's model, what is this measure?

Target word: measure type **Decides:** It counts whether a care step was done.

A	Wrong stem number	The time limit defines the process standard.
B	Adjacent category	Structure is staff, equipment, and setting.
C	Correct	Measures delivery of a care activity.
D	Confusion set	The fall rate would be the outcome.

7. Answer A Concept 4 · transfer

Which of these is a structure measure?

Target word: identify structure **Decides:** Resources and setting.

A	Correct	A staffing resource = structure.
B	Confusion set	That is an outcome.
C	Inverted operation	A result for the patient, the opposite end of the model.
D	Adjacent category	That is a process.

8. Answer B Concept 5

Two knee-replacement programs at hospitals ~~with similar parking fees~~ report results. Program A costs \$30,000 per case, and 90% of patients reach target function at 90 days. Program B costs \$20,000 per case, and 90% reach target function. ~~Program B's surgeons are newer~~. Which program delivers more value?

Target word: higher value **Decides:** Same outcome at lower cost.

A	Dropped element	Ignores cost.
B	Correct	Value = outcome relative to cost.
C	Camouflage	Surgeon tenure is not in the value equation; outcomes are.
D	Inverted operation	Outcomes are equal; extra cost lowers value.

9. Answer C Concept 5 · transfer

Program X reaches the target outcome in 80% of patients at \$16,000 per case. Program Y reaches it in 90% at \$17,100 per case. Which has the lower cost per successful outcome?

Target word: cost per success **Decides:** Divide cost per case by success rate.

A	Absolute language	Clearing a threshold does not make costs equal.
B	Dropped element	Ignores the success rate.
C	Correct	$\$17,100 \div 0.90 = \$19,000$ vs. $\$16,000 \div 0.80 = \$20,000$.
D	Inverted operation	Multiplies by the success rate instead of dividing.

10. Answer B Concept 6

An 82-year-old patient with advanced heart failure at a hospital ~~that just opened a new wing~~ tells the team she wants to go home rather than have another procedure. Her son, ~~who lives out of state~~, wants everything done. She has decision-making capacity. What is the patient-centered action?

Target word: whose choice guides care **Decides:** A capable patient's informed preference.

A	Adjacent category	Family preferences do not override a capable patient.
B	Correct	Care follows a capable patient's values.
C	Absolute language	The patient with capacity decides.
D	Inverted operation	That is provider-centered, not patient-centered.

11. Answer D Concept 7

At a hospital pursuing high reliability, a new respiratory therapist notices a ventilator alarm setting that looks wrong during rounds led by a senior attending. ~~The hospital has 600 beds.~~ Which HRO principle should guide the team?

Target word: HRO principle **Decides:** The person with the relevant expertise must be heard.

A	Confusion set	A real HRO principle, but about avoiding easy explanations, not who speaks up.
B	Inverted operation	Hierarchy over expertise is what HROs avoid.
C	Absolute language	Distorts the principle into halting everything.
D	Correct	Expertise, not hierarchy, drives decisions in HROs.

12. Answer D Concept 8

An emergency department ~~with a new coffee bar~~ maps its process and finds patients wait 40 minutes between triage and being roomed while exam rooms sit empty. Which Lean response fits?

Target word: Lean fix **Decides:** Waiting with idle capacity = flow waste.

A	Adjacent category	Triage is not the bottleneck; rooms are idle.
B	Inverted operation	Accommodates waste instead of removing it.
C	Confusion set	The waste here is waiting.
D	Correct	Lean removes non-value-added waiting.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	8	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	2	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Just culture	Console human error, coach at-risk behavior, and sanction only reckless behavior; judge the behavior, not the outcome.	Punishing by severity of harm, or never holding anyone accountable.	An error plus how the person chose to act.
2	PDSA cycle	Plan (aim, prediction) → Do (small test) → Study (compare results to prediction) → Act (adopt, adapt, or abandon).	Jumping from one small success to full rollout, or mixing up Study and Act.	What the team just finished doing.
3	Systems thinking and the Swiss cheese model	Most harm comes from several layered system weaknesses lining up; root cause analysis fixes the system, not just the person.	Blaming or retraining only the last person to touch the patient.	Several contributing factors listed.
4	Donabedian structure, process, outcome	Structure = resources and setting; process = what care is done; outcome = the result for the patient.	Calling a care-completion rate an outcome.	“Percentage of patients who received...” vs. “rate of...”
5	Value in value-based care	Value = outcomes that matter to patients relative to the cost of achieving them.	Equating higher spending or lower price alone with higher value.	Two programs with outcomes and costs.
6	Patient-centered care	Care respects the informed preferences, needs, and values of a patient with decision-making capacity.	Letting family or clinicians override a capable patient’s choice.	A capable patient and a disagreeing family member.
7	High reliability principles	HROs defer to expertise: the person with the most relevant knowledge is heard, whatever their rank.	Deferring to the highest-ranking person.	A junior staff member spots a risk.
8	Lean and waste	Lean redesigns flow to remove non-value-added steps such as waiting, motion, and rework.	Adding resources or space instead of fixing flow.	Idle capacity alongside long waits.

Course scope (public description): Organizational Systems and Healthcare Transformation covers foundational knowledge, skills, and attitudes toward organizational leadership within healthcare systems that can help students be successful. This course focuses on the concepts of patient safety, improvement science, fiscal responsiveness, quality of care, value-based care, and patient-centered care. Additional topics of quality science and innovation, systems redesign, and interprofessional roles assist the student in building necessary skills for healthcare transformation. All prior courses in the sequence for this program serve as prerequisites for this course.